

THE NULL HYPOTHESIS

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A poetic exploration of faith, doubt, and the return to belief

PART I: NULL HYPOTHESIS

Jesus Christ is God.

I went to church, not by force,
nor out of my own will—
but like a leaf upon the stream
that doesn't choose the river's path,
only flows.

I wore my Sunday best,
not knowing what Sunday meant.
I sang, but didn't know
to whom my voice was raised.

Hymns danced in stained-glass light,
bright with joy,
a lullaby of incense and hallelujahs—
but I did not know the words I sang.
They said virgin, I thought princess.
They said death, and I thought
of cartoons fading into clouds.
They said crucifixion, and I saw
a movie scene,
a man nailed but not known.
They said resurrection,
but my heart was still too small
to carry the weight of such a word.

I followed.
Because others did.
Because to kneel was to blend in,
to close my eyes was to be safe.
If I bowed, I belonged.
If I behaved, I was blessed.

It was all a trade—
obedience for protection,
piety for peace.
I was told:
Do this, and no trouble will come.
So I did this.
And I waited for the trouble not to come.

I never doubted.
But I never believed.
Not truly.
I was too young to deny
what I'd never truly received.
Too soft of soul to resist,
too hollow of heart to grasp.

And they said Jesus Christ is God—
I nodded, but what is God
to a child who thinks
genies grant wishes,
and angels are cartoons with wings?

It was all melody and motion,
a fun escape from arithmetic and lunch lines.
I sang because the music soared,
not because I understood
the gravity of grace.

But I forgive that child.
He was not meant to comprehend
what even the wise can't hold.
And I do not regret the coming storm—
for even rebellion is more holy

than hollow agreement.
 Better to wrestle angels in the dark
 than dance with shadows in the light.

Better to fall from faith
 than never to feel
 its weight at all.



PART II: REBELLION

Null Hypothesis: In doubt.

I grew older—and the stories stayed the same, but my questions sharpened like stones in a boy's pocket, ready to throw.

They said God parted seas— I saw only physics, unchanged and unmoved by prayer or stick. They said manna rained from heaven— I opened my textbook and read about photosynthesis and cloud formations. They said stoning was justice, flooding the earth was love, and I looked at the sky and wondered what kind of God drowns His creation just to watch it crawl back gasping and obedient.

The miracles turned myth in the fluorescence of science class. Donkey jawbone warfare? Chariots to heaven? A man swallowing a fish, or a fish swallowing a man? I saw biology, not parables. I saw neurons, not angels. And I began to turn.

I began to burn.

I read the New Testament— gentler, yes. But by then my mind had calloused. My trust had been bruised by genocide in Genesis and silence in suffering. Even the Jesus who loved and healed was painted with a brush I now believed was dipped in fear.

I started seeing the pulpit as a puppet show— a man with polished shoes pulling strings with scriptures, preaching heaven, while passing the plate.

I saw religion as control— fear masquerading as reverence, obedience bought with the threat of hell, donations wrapped in divine obligation.

And so I cursed it. All of it. Not with quiet doubt, but with rage.

I mocked the hymns I once mouthed, shouted blasphemies with pride, skipped fasts and scoffed at abstinence, drank to defy, slept to spite, broke every rule just to feel that I was finally free.

The child had bowed, but the teenager stood tall, fists clenched, eyes dry, no longer waiting for the trouble not to come— but inviting it.

If faith was a fire, I wanted to extinguish it. I wanted to prove that the Null Hypothesis was not just null— but nonsense.

And in doing so, I became the storm I thought I'd been spared.



PART III: THE LAB OF BELIEF

Null Hypothesis: In pursuit of disproof.

My parents wept
the way pillars weep when their temple crumbles—
not loud,
but heavy.
They watched me throw Bibles like old myths,
as if setting fire to ghosts could warm my cold resolve.

I was no longer a rebel.
I was a scientist in a warcoat,
armed with textbooks and equations,
stripping stories of their skin
to weigh the bones for truth.

I read Darwin like scripture.
I preached selection and mutation

with the zeal of a convert.
Adam from mud? Absurd.
Eve from a rib? Primitive folklore.
I held up the double helix like a sword
and slashed Eden from my memory.

I studied rivers—not parted,
but measured in flow rate and friction loss.
No man parts water without pumps or lies.
I studied gravity—not suspended,
but absolute.
No chariot burns skyward without fuel and physics.
I read equations like psalms
and laughed at fire-called prophets.

The Bible became a case file.
Each verse a fingerprint,
each miracle a suspect.
I devoured apocrypha like a prosecutor—
Nag Hammadi, Gospel of Thomas,
fragments buried in desert jars.
If there was a crack,
I would find it.
If there was a flaw,
I would expose it.

I mocked Christ
but couldn't explain why His name still stung.
I dismissed the Cross,
but the shadow it cast
kept following me through every lab,
every footnote,
every cold, clinical paragraph.

I read Dawkins like a disciple,
and Hitchens like a prophet,
and still—
a strange disquiet.
As if something in me knew:
It is easier to disprove zero
than to disprove
Jesus Christ.

I called it myth.
I called it madness.
But then I found
relics,
records,
letters scrawled in martyr's ink,
peer-reviewed by blood and broken bones.

Eyewitnesses.
Testimonies that outlived their torturers.
Church fathers who wrote before the ink of empire dried.
Fragments older than my doubt,
older than the creeds I mocked.

The data stacked like sediment—
undeniable, ancient,
fiercely preserved.

And I realized:
to disprove Christ existed
was like trying to erase
Isaac Newton
by burning his calculus.
History did not care

for my cynicism.

And my hypothesis,
once declared with thunder,
began to tremble.



PART IV: THE RELUCTANT RETURN

Null Hypothesis: Under Review.

I kept studying.
Not to believe,
but to bury belief once and for all.

I listened to arguments
like a jury hoping for a guilty verdict—
but the case refused to close.

How did they all say the same thing?
The disciples—
skinned, crucified, beheaded,
boiled alive.
Yet none recanted.
No hidden confession.
No last breath of regret.

Bartholomew,
preaching flayed and bleeding—
who dies for a lie they invented?

Maybe, I thought,

they missed Him so much,
they hallucinated.
Grief does strange things.
But group hallucinations?
Shared delusions
that touched hands,
ate fish,
walked forty days
through breath and bone?

Even Thomas,
the skeptic's saint,
demanded scars
before surrendering.
He did not bow to stories—
he touched the torn flesh
and called it God.

And what of the five hundred?
The meals?
The ascension?
A hallucination does not linger
for forty days,
does not eat,
does not bless,
does not break bread
before rising beyond sight.

My confidence cracked
like bad theory under peer review.

I watched Paul—
Christian killer,

zealot of the empire—
fall blind
and rise baptized.
A scholar of slaughter
turning apostle overnight.
He gained sight only
after losing everything
but truth.

Who was I to say
they were all deceived?
That Rome couldn't break them
but my certainty could?

Science,
in all its brilliance,
could not bury Christ
after two thousand years.
He remained—
the most cited,
the most followed,
the most loved,
the most denied.

Either everyone was mad,
or my hypothesis was falling apart.

What weight does my doubt hold
against the skull of Mary Magdalene,
the tombs of disciples,
the dust of Gethsemane,
the ink of the martyrs,
the testimonies of skeptics

turned saints?

To say,
“I haven’t seen Him—
therefore He is not,”
is to say
Pluto is fiction
for hiding in the dark.

And so my logic
buckled.

Like a young theorist
whose proud paper
is dismantled
by peer-reviewed fire.

I could no longer deny
what refused to be denied.
Not with the evidence,
not with the blood.

I did not leap into belief—
I crawled.
Doubt clung like a second skin.
But each question,
each challenge,
each chapter I reopened,
led not to collapse
but to quiet awe.

It became easier to believe

1 + 1 = 3
 than to deny
 that Christ rose from the dead.

They spoke of God
 in distant stars and sacred halls,
 But I felt His whisper
 deep beneath my skin.
 The altar's glow was
 never quite enough—
 For light was kindling
 in the shadows of my soul.
 I searched for signs
 beyond the veil of words,
 And found
 the silence held a secret language.

And so,
 slowly,
 reluctantly,
 still wrestling,
 I turned my face again
 toward the tomb—
 and found it
 empty.



PART V: THE NULL HOLDS

Null Hypothesis: Failed to reject.

I watched Him bleed on screens, and something in me broke. Not the blood,
 not the nails— but the eyes. Eyes that wept like mine and still forgave. In

The Chosen, in *The Passion*, in *Risen*— He stopped being myth and became a man. And in becoming man, He became God to me.

I read again— the New Testament shimmered like it had waited for me to be ready. The words—so simple, so unnervingly clean— written by hands once rough with rope and fish, carried the weight of eternity.

I began to fall. Not out of fear, but from exhaustion. Nights of tears, sickness in body and spirit, as I tried, desperately, to disprove Him.

But I couldn't.

Either Christianity is true, or this tale was written with such surgical perfection that only God Himself could have faked it. What a paradox.

I saw Christian homes— not primitive nor blind, but sharp, well-read, anchored in compassion and intellect. Houses built on rock where joy was not forced and truth did not tremble under scrutiny.

I am Christian— a phrase whispered in courage and shouted in chains. It still terrifies tyrants, still echoes in cathedrals and courtrooms and broken hearts.

And still, I struggled.

I could not love every ritual, nor obey without wrestling. But Christ— His message, His mercy, His mind— was flawless.

Not only nailed in wood and stone, But written in the bones of my becoming.

The Spirit does not come from skies afar— It rises where the question burns, within.

The truth they told was wrapped in ancient robes, Yet the spark lay quiet, waiting to be known.

He was never just a name to praise, But the pulse beneath the searching gaze.

Not just the answer told in sermons, But the restless yearning in the heart's quiet corners.

Christ is not a tale that ends, But the echo in the questions that never rest.

I am Gnostic still. I seek truth through reason, knowledge, and inner awakening. And Gnosticism says: the world was created by the Demiurge—

a lesser god, blind and arrogant, the very God we see in the Old Testament—the one who drowned the earth, demanded blood, commanded fear.

But behind him, above him, before him, is the Monad— the source of all that is, the nameless light from which all truth flows. Where the Demiurge said *Obey or die*, the Monad whispers: *Know, and live*.

And I began to wonder— if this world feels broken, maybe it's because we are the fragments of that false creator. Maybe we are the blind ones now.

But Christ— He was not blind. He was not of this world. He came from the Light. And when He spoke, even my logic held its breath.

So I turn to the Monad. To the Father behind the veil. To the Source from which even gods must answer. And I pray— not in tradition, not in Latin, but in the ancient tongue that Jesus spoke:

Abwoon D'bashmaya
Nethqadash Shmakh
Teytey Malkuthakh

(Our Father in Heaven,
 Holy is Your Name,
 Your Kingdom come.)

Because I failed to reject the Null Hypothesis.
 Christ stands. The tomb is empty. And I—
 I can't disprove it.

So as far as I'm concerned, Long live the King.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Pearl Bipin Pulickal is an engineering graduate from the National Institute of Technology Goa, with a background in electronics and communication. His academic interests span applied mathematics, signal theory, cosmology, and artificial intelligence. He is currently exploring interdisciplinary research

problems at the intersection of mathematics, computing, and the physical sciences.

Pearl approaches inquiry with a deep respect for empirical evidence and logical consistency. He does not adhere to religious belief or cultural narratives without subjecting them to rigorous questioning and doubt. His work reflects a commitment to understanding the universe through testable models, mathematical clarity, and careful reasoning—rather than faith, tradition, or dogma.

He is most comfortable in the company of scientific uncertainty, and believes that progress is driven not by conviction, but by curiosity, skepticism, and the willingness to revise one's views in light of better evidence.

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¹In Gnostic belief, the Demiurge is the God of the Old Testament, a false creator god who crafted the flawed material world. The Monad, by contrast, is the ineffable source of all true divinity and light.